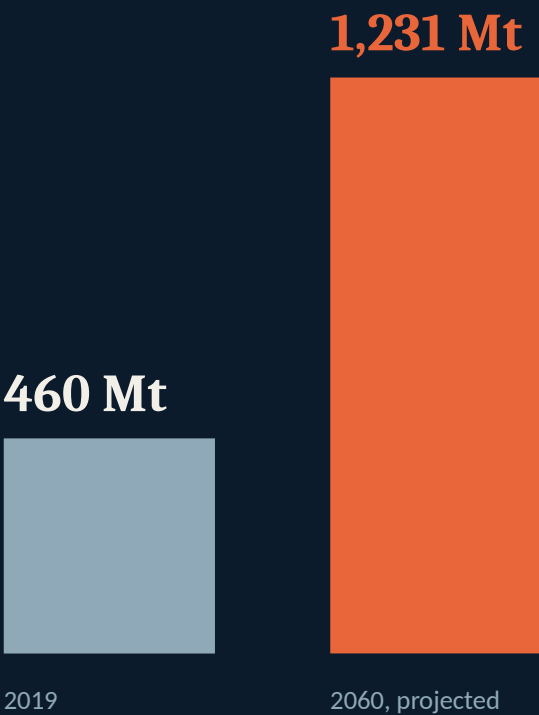




Source: OECD Global Plastics Outlook, 2022

The treaty that failed twice

And what that did to a movement

Cesco Cugliari

One resolution, five sessions, no treaty

In March 2022, 175 countries agreed to negotiate a binding treaty covering the **[full life cycle]** of plastic. Production, use, disposal.

That deadline came and went. So did the next one.



Both rounds died on the same split

HIGH AMBITION COALITION

70+ countries

Panama, Rwanda, the EU. They want binding caps on [production].

“We will not betray future generations.”

Panama's delegate, Geneva, Aug 2025. Membership: HAC, Aug 2025.

LIKE-MINDED GROUP

Saudi Arabia, Russia

Oil-producing states. They want a treaty about bins and recycling. Waste only.

234

fossil-fuel and chemical lobbyists registered at Geneva. More people than the entire EU delegation.

Source: CIEL analysis of the INC-5.2 participant list, Aug 2025

Is plastic a waste problem or a **[production]** problem?

WASTE

Clean it up. Recycle better. Blame the consumer.

PRODUCTION

Cap it at source. Ban toxic additives. Sue the maker.

154 square brackets remain in the chair's August 2026 draft text (UNEP). Each one is a fight nobody has won yet.

Losing twice radicalised the movement



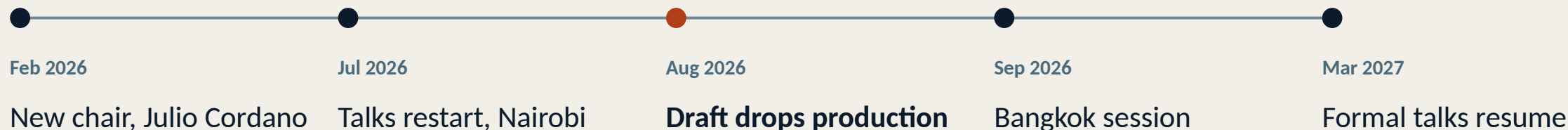
Sources: CIEL; Coca-Cola 2030 target revision, Dec 2024; California Attorney General.

Alive, but shrinking

WHAT THE CHAIR TOOK OUT

[production]

Cut from the chair's August 2026 draft. France called it disappointing.



Sources: IISD Earth Negotiations Bulletin; UNEP; Climate Home News.

Is a **[weak]** treaty better than no treaty?